



PHIL SORRELLS
Criminal District Attorney
Tarrant County

April 30, 2026

Ms. Kathryn Copeland
Copeland Law
1137 S. Pine Street
Grapevine, Texas 76051

Via E-Mail

Re: Letter dated April 20, 2026 to the County Administrator

Ms. Copeland,

I am in receipt of your correspondence dated April 20, 2026, which was addressed to County Administrator Chandler Merritt. After reviewing this letter and the attached exhibits, I understand you have concerns regarding the provision of ADA accommodations during the course of your family court judicial proceedings.

First, I understand that you requested ADA accommodations from Tarrant County District Court Judges and were dissatisfied with their decisions. As the County communicated to you upon your initial request to the County for judicial ADA accommodations, the County does not have control over a particular state District Court Judge's decision when a litigant seeks ADA accommodations that would modify court proceedings. Such a decision relates to a judge's adjudicative responsibilities and is within a judge's sole discretion. Tarrant County, on the other hand, provides assistance for those with disabilities that prevent them from accessing and navigating the County's physical facilities, programs, services, and activities, whether in person or virtually. While I understand you are frustrated and feel the process is fragmented, your case took place in a state District Court that is located within, but not controlled by, Tarrant County. Thus, concerns with the state court ADA accommodation process are not properly presented to Tarrant County because the County cannot control or change the outcome of your legal proceedings.

Your letter also requests certain documents. It is my understanding that you submitted an open records request that mirrors your request for records in your April 20 correspondence, and

that the open records request was closed on or about April 21, 2026. Thus, you have received the records in the County's possession that are responsive to your request.

Finally, you expressed concerns with the County's Title II compliance. Tarrant County takes its obligations under Title II seriously and remains committed to ensuring all individuals, including those with disabilities, have access to the County. As your frustrations relate to judicial decisions and do not outline any issues accessing County facilities or programs, it does not appear that the County is required to take corrective action based on the allegations you presented.

Thank you for giving us an opportunity to review and address your concerns. If you have any additional questions regarding the County's ADA policies, please contact me directly.

Sincerely,

Phil Sorrells
Criminal District Attorney
Tarrant County, Texas

Katherine E. Owens

KATHERINE E. OWENS
Assistant Criminal District Attorney

KEO/psm